

SYED AIJAZ HASSAN

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WORK AUTHORIZATION

H1B Visa Status: Currently employed under H1B visa status.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computers, Sri Venkateshwara University, 1998

- Degree attested by Government of India and Sultanate of Oman

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate | Microsoft Certified Azure Administrator – Associate
|TrendMicro XDR Certificate | Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer (MCSE) | Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) | ISO ISMS 27001:2022 Certification | Huawei HCIP Certified | Dell Partner Certification
| Barracuda Email Security Professional

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dynamic and forward-thinking Multi-Cloud and Systems Administrator with over 16 years of expertise in designing, managing, and optimizing scalable IT infrastructures across AWS, Azure, and VMware platforms. Renowned for driving cost-efficient cloud migrations and developing innovative Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) solutions, reducing operational costs by 20% while ensuring seamless scalability and high availability. Adept at implementing enterprise-grade security protocols, including endpoint protection and network fortifications, leading to a 30% reduction in security incidents. Proficient in orchestrating complex virtualization environments, disaster recovery solutions, and high-availability frameworks, delivering 15% infrastructure cost savings and earning recognition for outstanding leadership. Skilled in leading cross-functional teams, fostering collaboration, and aligning IT strategies with organizational goals to maximize business outcomes. Demonstrated ability to automate processes, optimize performance, and deliver innovative solutions tailored to the demands of fast-paced industries. Recognized for leveraging emerging technologies to solve critical business challenges while consistently ensuring operational excellence and customer satisfaction.

KEY COMPETENCIES

Cloud Solutions:

- Architected and managed cloud environments across AWS and Azure (EC2, S3, RDS, Azure VMs, Blob Storage) to achieve high availability, scalability, and cost-efficiency.
- Hands-on experience with Infrastructure as Code (IaC) tools like Terraform and CloudFormation for automated resource provisioning.
- Developed serverless applications using AWS Lambda, API Gateway, and DynamoDB, ensuring seamless integration and performance optimization.
- Led on-premises to cloud migrations, reducing operational costs by 20% and ensuring minimal downtime.
- Designed and implemented hybrid cloud architectures, ensuring seamless interoperability between

cloud and on-premises systems. Virtualization & Infrastructure Optimization:

- Deployed and managed VMware environments (vSphere, ESXi, vSAN), ensuring high availability, disaster recovery readiness, and optimal performance for critical workloads.
- Designed robust systems for data backup and disaster recovery using Veeam Backup & Replication, safeguarding enterprise data and minimizing downtime.
- Configured and optimized virtual workloads, ensuring efficient resource

utilization and security compliance. Security & Networking:

- Proficient in implementing Fortigate and SonicWall firewalls, IPsec VPNs, and Site-to-Site VPNs for secure and reliable network communication.
- Configured secure networking solutions for AWS environments, including Security Groups, VPC, and NAT Gateways, to protect sensitive data and maintain compliance.
- Expertise in endpoint security solutions, achieving a 30% reduction in security incidents through proactive measures and advanced configurations.

Systems Administration:

- Managed enterprise IT systems, including Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, and Microsoft 365, ensuring seamless operations and user satisfaction.

- Automated routine IT tasks, including user onboarding/offboarding and privileged account management, using CyberArk APIs and custom scripts.
- Delivered 15% cost savings by optimizing IT infrastructure budgets and renegotiating vendor contracts.
- Experienced in maintaining and supporting Windows Servers, Exchange Online,

SharePoint, and Teams integrations. Backup and Disaster Recovery:

- Implemented enterprise-grade backup and recovery solutions using Veeam Backup & Replication, ensuring data protection and business continuity.
- Monitored backup health, conducted regular restores, and maintained disaster recovery readiness for all mission-critical systems.

Information Security Management (ISO 27001 Compliance)

- Developed and implemented ISO 27001-compliant Information Security Management Systems (ISMS) to protect sensitive organizational data and ensure regulatory compliance.
- Conducted risk assessments and gap analyses to identify vulnerabilities, applying corrective actions to achieve ISO 27001 certification readiness.
- Designed and enforced policies and procedures aligned with ISO 27001 standards, ensuring confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information assets.
- Performed internal audits to monitor compliance with ISO 27001 requirements and supported external audit processes for certification.
- Managed documentation and evidence for compliance, including Statement of Applicability (SoA) and risk treatment plans.

WORK HISTORY

Cloud and Systems Administrator, Mohsin Hyder Darwish LLC | 2022 – Present

- Designed and deployed Azure-based cloud architectures that were scalable, secure, and cost-efficient, enabling seamless operations and alignment with industry best practices for enterprise cloud computing.
- Spearheaded the migration of on-premises data centers to Azure cloud, employing workload assessments, rehosting strategies, and hybrid configurations, reducing downtime by 30% and operational costs by 20%.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and manage databases using Azure SQL Database, Cosmos DB, and Azure Cognitive Search, achieving optimal performance and improved query speeds.
- Implemented Infrastructure as Code (IaC) strategies using Terraform and Azure Resource Manager (ARM) templates, automating resource provisioning and achieving improvement in deployment efficiency.
- Managed VMware environments (vSphere, ESXi, vSAN) by deploying ESXi hosts, configuring distributed resource scheduling (DRS), and implementing fault tolerance (FT), ensuring 99.97% system uptime for mission-critical workloads.
- Directed and optimized enterprise-wide backup and disaster recovery strategies using Veeam Backup & Replication 12.0, ensuring a 100% success rate in data recovery and compliance with organizational policies.
- Implemented robust email security solutions using Barracuda Email Security, minimizing spam and security threats and improving email communication reliability.
- Led cost optimization initiatives by budgeting for hardware and software renewals, negotiating vendor contracts, and achieving a reduction in IT infrastructure expenditures.
- Championed automation initiatives, streamline tasks such as user onboarding, license allocation, and security policy enforcement, reducing manual efforts.
- Collaborated with product teams across industries to deploy Azure services, including virtual networks, application gateways, and storage accounts, enhancing scalability and operational efficiency.

IT Head, Loay International LLC | 2006 – 2022

- Designed and managed virtualized IT environments, implementing auto-scaling and high-availability configurations to ensure seamless operations and cost-efficiency across critical enterprise systems.
- Led the deployment and optimization of AWS services such as S3 (with lifecycle policies and cross-region replication), RDS for MySQL and PostgreSQL databases, and Route 53 for failover routing, resulting improvement in application reliability and redundancy.
- Architected serverless solutions using AWS Lambda, API Gateway, and DynamoDB for event-driven architectures, enhancing system performance and reducing execution costs.
- Developed and implemented Infrastructure as Code (IaC) templates via Terraform and CloudFormation,

achieving consistent resource deployment across multi-environment infrastructures and reducing time.

- Configured and optimized content delivery networks (CDNs) to accelerate global website and application performance, reducing latency and improving user experience.
- Deployed Kubernetes clusters using AWS Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS), enabling scalable and reliable containerized applications to support high-traffic environments.
- Designed and enforced security best practices, configuring least-privilege access policies, NAT gateways, VPC configurations, and VPNs to secure data in isolated network environments.
- Automated CI/CD pipelines using AWS CodePipeline, significantly improving development workflows and accelerating deployment cycles.
- Optimized database-driven applications, managing backups, implementing failover strategies, and enhancing performance for MySQL and PostgreSQL instances.
- Proactively monitored and resolved performance issues, creating custom metrics and alerts that reduced downtime.

IT Assurance Manager (Project), Shell Development of Oman, Muscat, March 2012 – April 2013

- Provided high-priority technical support to VIP users, ensuring uninterrupted access to critical enterprise systems and minimizing service disruptions.
- Managed the registration and administration of VASCO Tokens for MOP accounts, enhancing secure access control across enterprise platforms.
- Identified and resolved operational issues related to network connectivity, Internet, Intranet, and Live Link platforms, resulting in a 25% reduction in system downtime.
- Mitigated security vulnerabilities by deploying timely system updates, patches, and compliance enhancements, improving overall security posture and regulatory adherence.
- Streamlined tape handling processes for T-Systems, ensuring the efficient management of critical data backups and recovery procedures.
- Contributed to the AT&T Transformation Project, optimizing IT processes and workflows to enhance operational efficiency and reduce bottlenecks.

IT Support (Project), Muscat Electricity Distribution Company SAOG, Muscat, Jan 2010 – Jan 2011

- Managed and optimized Microsoft Exchange 2007 to ensure reliable email server performance, high availability, and seamless communication across the organization.
- Administered and maintained Cisco routers, switches, MPLS networks, and wireless connectivity, enabling secure and efficient network operations across multiple locations.
- Implemented and provided support for Back Office and Front Office applications, reducing system downtime and improving end-user productivity.
- Collaborated with Help Desk teams to resolve escalated technical issues, enhancing customer satisfaction and maintaining SLA compliance.
- Configured and managed the Manage Engine Service Desk platform, streamlining ticketing processes and improving resolution efficiency.

IT Support (Project), Ministry of Defense, Sultanate of Oman, Jan 2006 – Jan 2010

- Procured, deployed, and maintained hardware and software systems, ensuring IT infrastructure readiness and supporting organizational goals.
- Provided on-site technical support and incident resolution, achieving a 95% first-call resolution rate and minimizing downtime for critical systems.
- Administered email account creation and management, streamlining communication processes and optimizing user productivity.
- Conducted regular hardware and software performance evaluations, recommending and implementing upgrades to improve operational efficiency.
- Maintained detailed documentation of IT inventory and configurations, enhancing asset tracking and facilitating seamless IT operations.
- Participated in technology evaluation and selection processes, ensuring alignment of IT systems with organizational objectives and emerging technologies.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Cloud Platforms

- AWS: EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Elastic Beanstalk, Route 53, VPC, CloudFormation, EKS (Elastic Kubernetes Service), AWS Backup.
- Azure: Virtual Machines, Blob Storage, SQL Database, Cosmos DB, Cognitive Search, Azure Resource Manager (ARM) Templates, Application Gateways.

Virtualization

- VMware: vSphere (versions 6.7, 7.0, 8.0), ESXi, vSAN, Distributed Resource Scheduling (DRS), High Availability (HA), Fault Tolerance (FT). Backup Solutions
- Veeam Backup & Replication (version 12.0): Backup jobs, disaster recovery strategies, data repository management, monitoring and restoration processes.

Networking

- Firewalls: Fortigate, SonicWall (content filtering, IPsec VPN, Site-to-Site VPN).
- Networking Tools: NAT Gateways, Security Groups, Load Balancers, DHCP, DNS.
- Monitoring Tools: SolarWinds for network health monitoring and issue

troubleshooting. Security

- Endpoint Protection: TrendMicro XDR Implementing advanced endpoint security solutions, reducing security incidents
- Barracuda Email Security: Spam filtering, email archiving, encryption policies, and threat protection monitoring.
- Arcon: Privileged account management, API integration for automation, and adherence to security compliance.

Automation Tools

- Infrastructure as Code (IaC): Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Azure Resource Manager (ARM) Templates.
- Scripting: PowerShell, Python (for process automation, incident

resolution, and reporting). Systems Administration

- Microsoft 365: User management, license allocation, Exchange Online, SharePoint Online, and Teams integration.
- Active Directory: Group policy management, user creation, security enhancements, and

domain configurations. Data Management

- Database Platforms: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Azure SQL Database, NoSQL (DynamoDB, Cosmos DB).
- CDN Configuration: Performance optimization for global

application delivery. CI/CD and DevOps

- CI/CD Pipelines: AWS CodePipeline for automated development workflows and deployments.
- Kubernetes: Deploying and managing Kubernetes clusters using AWS Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS) for containerized applications.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Successfully migrated legacy on-premises systems to AWS and Azure cloud infrastructures, achieving reduction in operational costs while ensuring scalability and high availability.
- Implemented enterprise-grade endpoint security solutions and advanced threat protection measures, leading to a 30% reduction in security incidents and improved compliance with regulatory standards.
- Spearheaded the restructuring of IT systems, including VMware environments and Active Directory, resulting in 15% infrastructure cost savings and enhanced system performance.
- Designed and implemented robust backup strategies using Veeam Backup & Replication, ensuring 100% recovery success rates and minimizing downtime for mission-critical systems.
- Leveraged automation tools such as Terraform, CloudFormation, and Python scripts to reduce deployment times by 40% and eliminate repetitive manual tasks, increasing operational efficiency.
- Designed scalable cloud solutions using AWS and Azure, implementing Infrastructure as Code (IaC) practices that reduced resource provisioning times by 40%.
- Awarded Employee of the Year for exceptional contributions to IT governance, process improvements, and leadership in critical IT transformation projects.
- Configured and optimized content delivery networks (CDNs), reducing latency and improving global application performance by 35%.
- Process Improvement: Improved ticket resolution efficiency by 20% through effective configuration and management of IT Service Desk platforms like Manage Engine.
- Ensured 99.97% system uptime across critical IT platforms by implementing advanced fault tolerance, high availability configurations, and proactive monitoring strategies.